



We Are Southeast Asia



Modern & Contemporary Southeast Asian Art







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We Are Southeast Asia

Modern & Contemporary

Southeast Asian Art

AUCTION IN LONDON

8 November 2019 (Friday)

2 pm

(9 pm Jakarta | 10 pm Singapore/Hong Kong/Manila)

VIEWING

6 November 2019 (Wednesday)

1 pm - 7 pm

7 November 2019 (Thursday)

10.30 am - 7 pm

8 November 2019 (Friday)

10.30 am - 1.30 pm

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A STYLE TO REMEMBER

We Are Southeast Asia

By Viv Lawes, UK Consultant, One Larasati Arts

One of the characteristics of a mature art ecology is the historicization of movements that in the past represented the bogeymen of nations forging change and a concomitant new identity. Such was the *Mooi Indies* (Beautiful Indies) style of painting in Indonesia that, for the founders of the PERSAGI (The Indonesian Painters' Association), S. Sudjojono (1913–1986) and Agus Djaja (1913–1994), stood for everything that was wrong with art in Indonesia at the time. In the immediate pre-war period, railing against the imperialism of which *Mooi Indies* was the painterly embodiment – images of the people and landscape of Indonesia idealised in a golden light that rendered it an exotic Other to the Western centre of production – PERSAGI, when founded in 1938, was the new ideal for the avant-garde amongst Indonesian artists. Sudjojono felt art should be based on daily life as it really is, without mediation and in the individual style of the artist unencumbered by religion, ritual or exoticism.

Eighty years later, the *Mooi Indies* art of the 1920s and '30s practiced by both Dutch expatriates and Indonesians alike, is integrated into the art historical narrative of the archipelago. Two of the most prolific are represented in *We Are Southeast Asia*, Larasati's third auction in London: Willem Gerard Hoefker (1902–1981) and Johan Rudolf Bonnet (1895–1978). Their lush figurative works of highly contrasted velvety tones signify an art historiography that captures the last vestiges of colonial life in Indonesia. Their home, like many expats, was in Bali, which not only attracted artists from Europe but also from Asia. The latter included the seminal visit by key Chinese emigre artists from the Nanyang School in Singapore in 1952, which had a profound effect on the direction of art in Singapore. To prise apart exoticism and the desire for an environment conducive to creativity is fraught with difficulties: a Gordian Knot composed of the threads of the argument about nature versus nurture. While the consequences of colonialism and the complexities of postcolonial reformation run through the very fabric of affected countries and cannot be overestimated, a way of cutting through the knot when looking at individual art practices might be to say that exoticism can exist even at the closest quarters, and that creative inspiration may come from the visual and sensory stimuli springing from a simple change of scene. Antonio Blanco (1912–1999), an artist of Spanish roots born in Manila, is a prime example of both. He moved to Bali in 1952, after Indonesia had attained independence from Dutch rule, and spent the rest of his life there. The sensuality of his female figures, which dominated his oeuvre, arguably put him in the same camp as Hoefker and Bonnet, but the broken surface, swift brushstroke and fleeting colour introduce an expressionism that renders the figuration less idealised; this can be seen in *Eve and the Apple*, in which the firm flesh of the Balinese dancer fuses with the origin myth of the Bible.

Contrasting with the sensuousness of *Mooi Indies* and later figurative works is that of Koeboe Sarawan (b.1961), who appropriates the *wayang kulit* tradition of puppet theatre. This is based on the great Hindu epic poems the *Ramayana* and the *Mahabharata*, and has been deeply embedded into the performative arts of Indonesia since the 9th century.¹ The surrealistic overlay where Sarawan's puppets inhabit deserted landscapes, casting shadows that recall those of Giorgio de Chirico's dark, subversive figures, is a strong theme in Indonesian fine art, and is comparable to the disturbing later paintings and wood sculptures of Gregorius Sidharta (1932–2006). A similarly dark mood is evident in Djoko Pekik's (b.1938) *Dua Wanita Malam* (Two Women of the Night) and Arifien Nief's (b.1955) *Orchestra*. Pekik's women display the same static forms as *wayang kulit* puppets with frontal body positions and profile heads, bringing tradition and contemporary life together as one woman looks at her reflection in a hand mirror while the other draws heavily on a cigarette. They tell a story older than that of the Hindu epics – of women being trapped in an economic prison where they can only sell themselves to survive. Nief's figures are harder to read, with tiny

1) James Brandon, *On Thrones of Gold: Three Javanese Shadow Plays* (Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard University Press, 1970; reprint Honolulu: University of Hawaii Press, 1993), p.3. Accessed 26.10.19: <https://education.asianart.org/explore-resources/background-information/history-indonesian-puppet-theater-wayang>.

heads on monumental bodies expressively rendered in deeply contrasting light and shade lit by moonlight. Is the titular orchestra out of view as the figure in the dark red dress carrying flowers appears to approach another figure in shadow, or is the shadowed figure playing an instrument?

The minimalistic surrealism of Gusti Ayu Kadek Murniasih (1966-2006) arguably represents the intersection of the contemporary art world with distinctive Balinese painting traditions. She is the only artist in the present show to have been born in Bali, and she trained with the Pengosekan-based Dewa Putu Mokoh (1934-2010). He was from a family closely tied with the *wayang* style in the Pita Maha artists' association, which was a collective formed in 1936 by Tjokorda Agung Sukawati, Prince of Ubud, modern Balinese master Gusti Nyoman Lempad (c.1862-1978), Rudolf Bonnet and German artist Walter Spies (1895-1942). The Pita Maha style fused classical Balinese painting from Kamasan with individualistic modernism and secular themes, now known as Modern Traditional painting in Bali. Murniasih therefore comes through this art historical line twice removed, firstly by learning from Mokoh's individualistic rendering of intimate, everyday scenes that he reduced to simpler lines, and again through her own focus on gender issues and taboo images of a sexual nature. *Misteri* (Mystery) suggests the moment of fertilisation with the sperm-like profile of the female figure and the imminent meeting of her long hair with the free-floating lock encircled by an egg-like form. *Purnama Berdasi* (Full Moon Tied) has a more scratchy, fragile line with the full moon 'tied' to amorphic forms and what appears to be a cake with candle, or a bomb. Human feet float into the picture, leaving the viewer charmed and uncertain in equal measure.

Vulnerability has a tougher external appearance in *Chaos* by Malaysian artist Yuki Tham (b.1992). She makes clear in her artist's statement that she aims to "capture the emotions and vulnerability of a person who is lost and confused." The hyper-realism of her technique works in concert with the momentary capture of the young woman's changeable emotions. The figure stands for Everywoman and embodies Tham's concerns about the ways in which youth can be devastated by the desire for experiences on the way to finding an identity. The same sense of universality is suggested through a contrastingly indirect approach by master Malaysian watercolourist Chang Fee Ming (b.1959), whose *Good Morning* is one of the few works in the group to exclude the human figure. Human presence is only suggested by the bundled batik cloth spilling out of the window in the wooden shack, an indexical sign of habitation within. We only know that the people who exist within are poor.

Returning to the opening topic of ways in which art ecologies demonstrate their maturity, another country which has historicised its colonial art practices is Vietnam. Its traces are clearly evident in the work of two Vietnamese artists included in *We Are Southeast Asia*, Lê Phổ (1907-2001) and Vũ Cao Đàm (1908-2000). Unlike the experience in Bali, French artists in Vietnam were not drawn by the fantasy image of escaping from industrialised Europe but by the employment provided at the École Supérieure des Beaux Arts de l'Indochine (ESBI), set up by colonial administrators in 1925. The school was set up some quarter of a century before the Indonesian equivalents, the postcolonial art schools of Bandung and Yogyakarta, and several generations of Vietnamese artists were trained in Western techniques before its closure in 1945. Lê Phổ spent most of his life in Paris and achieved both commercial success and critical recognition. The elongated form and spare lines of *Lady with Flower* are evident in his works in the 1930s onwards and sprung from his training under his teacher and later colleague, Victor Tardieu (1870-1937), co-founder with Nguyễn Nam Sơn (1890-1973) of ESBI and a close friend of Henri Matisse. Vũ Cao Đàm was also a graduate of ESBI, following a similar career trajectory to Lê Phổ and settling in France. His work *Divinité* shows the impact of Matisse and Chagall and the golden light not only of Southeast Asia but also the South of France, where he moved in the 1950s. The titular divinity directly recalls Buddhist iconography fused with the female form, reflecting the majority religion in Vietnam.

The oldest art schools in Southeast Asia are in the Philippines, where the impact of formal teaching in Western academic style was felt from the second quarter of the 19th century. While academicism may be long past there as elsewhere, the long history means that the Philippines has the most mature art ecology in Southeast Asia. Filipino artists dominate the remainder of *We Are Southeast Asia*, with familiar figures from recent auctions and exhibitions mounted in London and Singapore by Larasati's sister gallery, One East

Asia. The celebrated Andres Barrioquinto (b.1975) leads the field with *In This Light and On That Evening*, the latest in his series of works with the leitmotif of the peacock. The bird fuses with the profile of the beautiful woman and her characteristic veil of *ukiyo-e* figures showing courtesans and kabuki actors from Edo period Japan. Peacocks conflate with the human form, presenting physical beauty – the iridescence and luxuriance of the peacock and the youthful beauty of the human figure – as inseparable from the sense of alienation between the *grisaille* figure and technicolour nature. The peacock itself has a mixed symbolism in different cultures as both the protector from evil and harbinger of bad luck, lending uncertainty of reading to an image that seduces with colour and curvilinear form.

Jayson Cortez (b. 1986), a figurative artist with a deep personal religious convictions steeped in the Catholicism of his native Philippines, employs his characteristic device of hyper-realism and surrealism that references sepia-tinted black and white photography, a nod to the photographs that he uses to work from and subverts in a critique of the interplay between reality and perception. His painting *Fusion* pairs man with horse in a way that recalls the classical equestrian monument so familiar in bronze statuary in urban centres worldwide, which is itself a martial celebration of power embedded into an ancient relationship. His painting technique is based on rigorous draughtsmanship he learned from studying European masters such as Leonardo da Vinci, Rembrandt, Modigliani and Francis Bacon. It is an uplifting image, in which Cortez uses his regular device of obscuring the face with flowers to signify human goodness, perhaps even harking back to the three theological virtues of Faith, Hope and Charity. The same device is used in *Mechanical Wings*, in which his avatar “Bogi Man” appears clad entirely in black, zipped leather biking leathers, with his head encircled by flowers. This male figure represents the other side to Cortez’s predominantly female figuration but presents an equally optimistic outlook on humanity: the man is tough on the outside but soft and gentle within.

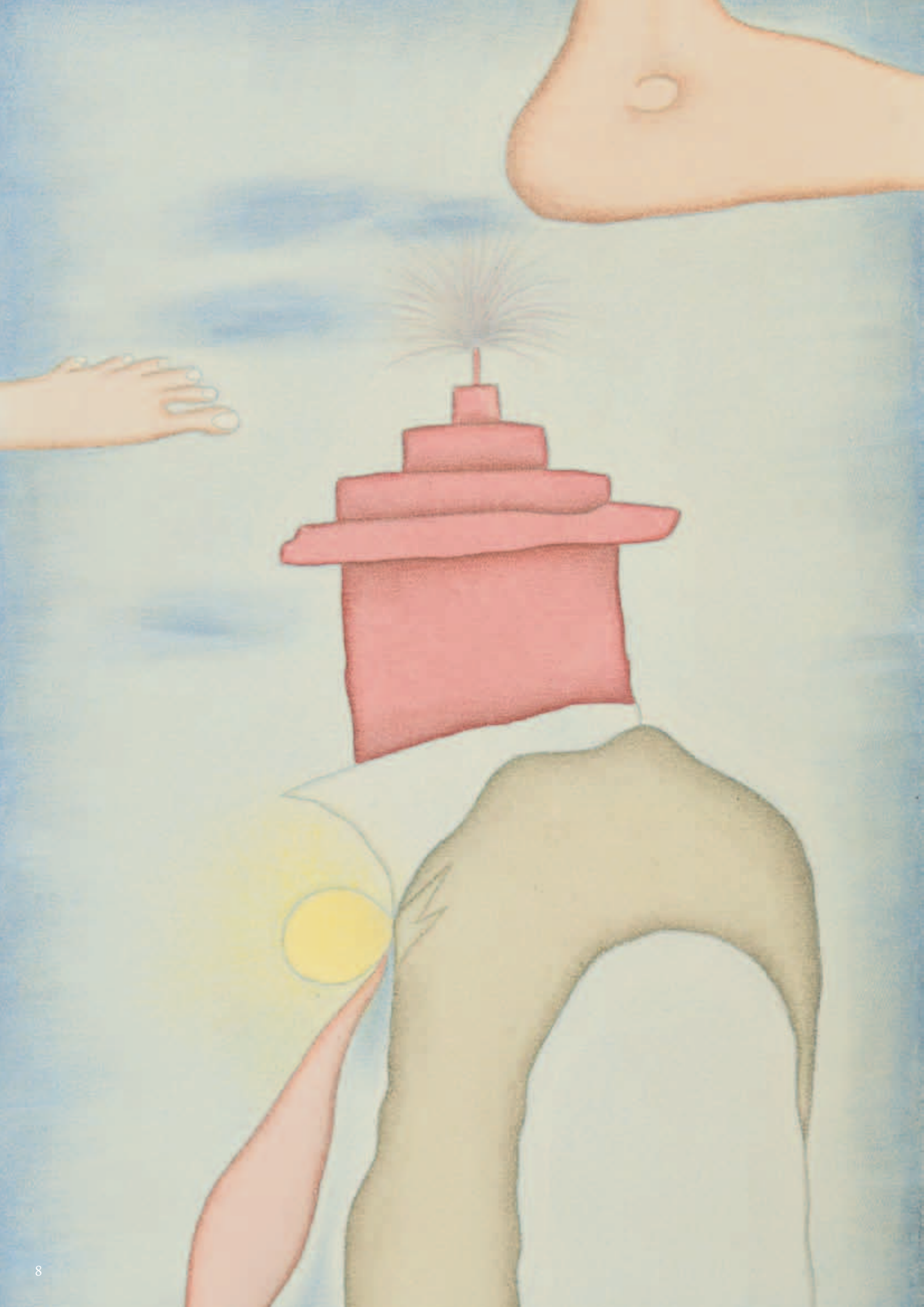
Gentleness is certainly not the theme in Jerry Elizalde Navarro’s (1924-1999) colour-saturated *Awesome in Her Beauty*, a title that is taken from the artist’s own statement, “Awesome in her beauty, when mother earth heaves and sighs, man trembles.” This work is about power, an ecstatic, expressionist vision that venerates the very essence of existence, recalling Plato’s Theory of Forms. This theory argues that the realm of unchanging concepts, Forms, exists beyond time and space and represents the truth of existence; the physical world is a mere shadow copy of the Forms, and are subject to constant change and perceptions. Navarro’s painted form is his effort, in the physical world of shadows, to get close to the power of nature’s essential being.

There is a different kind of ecstasy in *Aura* by Welbart (b.1971), more of a calm joyfulness. His personal mantra is that happiness comes from “the unity of my mind, my heart and my soul,” and so it is inward, meditative practices that allow one to reach the truth of existence. His recent work is centred around the motif of the lone female figure with an aura of inscribed meditations blooming from her head to invoke love, wisdom and peace. In *Aura* her head is disembodied, as are her hands, in which she holds a rose, a sign of inner beauty with simplicity and singularity at its core. The human head is, by contrast, turned inside out in the work of Abi Dionisio (b.1987). *Hidden Sanctuary* is the latest in her series of works that use the visual and conceptual interplay between paint and embroidery in her images of the human form. She is known for her hand-stitched embroidered portraits, in which she finds what she calls the “Other Side of Beauty” on their reverse. These form a record of the image-making process abstracted from the “face” of the artwork, which she then applies with paint and uses it to create a print onto paper or canvas. This is then worked up in paint into the final image. In *Hidden Sanctuary* the flowers that are stitched/ painted into the head signify a form of protection of the inner person from the outer world.



DESIGNER: JEFFREY M. HARRIS

AWESOME INTERIORS
WHICH INSPIRE THEM TO LIVE
WITH COURAGE



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lot 816, Jerry Elizalde Navarro, *Awesome in Her Beauty* (1996), acrylic on canvas

lot 808, Yuki Tham, *Chaos* (2019), oil on canvas

lot 814, Jayson Cortez, *Mechanical Wings* (2019), oil on canvas

lot 812, Abi Dionisio, *Hidden Sanctuary* (2019), oil on canvas

lot 821, Chang Fee Ming, *Good Morning* (1992), watercolour on paper



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LOT 801 - 821







801

HOFKER, WILLEM GERARD

(1902 - 1981, Dutch)

Ni Kenjoen with Lamplight

mezzotint; 35 x 25 cm

signed on lower left, numbered 46/100 and
"Epr. d'artiste" on lower right

£ 500 - 700

(US\$ 642 - 899)

Provenance: Private Collection, Europe



802

HOFKER, WILLEM GERARD

(1902 - 1981, Dutch)

Ni Gusti Made Toewi at the Gate

etching; 51 x 27.5 cm; signed and titled

£ 600 - 800

(US\$ 771 - 1,028)

Provenance: Private Collection, Europe



803

BONNET, JOHAN RUDOLF

(1985 - 1978, Dutch)

Portrait of a Girl

mixed media on paper; 36 x 22 cm
signed on lower left

£ 400 - 600

(US\$ 514 - 771)

Provenance: Private Collection, Europe

Literature:

Ruud Spruit, *Indonesische impressies, oostrese thema's in de westerse schilderkunst* (Indonesian impressions, oriental themes in western painting), Wijk en Aalburg 1992, illustrated, p. 60.

804

BLANCO, ANTONIO

(1911 - 1999, Spanish-Indonesian)

Eve and the Apple

mixed media on paper; 50 x 28 cm
signed on the middle

£ 8,000 - 10,000

(US\$ 10,274 - 12,842)

Provenance:

- Sotheby's Hong Kong, Modern and Contemporary Southeast Asian Art, 3 April 2017
- Private Collection, Asia





805

ARIFIEN NEIF

(b. 1955, Indonesian)

Brief Encounter

1988; oil on canvas; 33 x 28 cm
signed and dated on lower right

£ 1,300 - 1,800

(US\$ 1,670 - 2,313)

Provenance: Private Collection, Asia

Literature: *Arifien : The Life and Fantasy of an Emerging Indonesian Painter* (Museum Pelita Harapan Press, 1997).
Illustrated in colour, p. 184



806

DJOKO PEKIK

(b. 1938, Indonesian)

Dua Wanita Malam

1996; oil on canvas; 25 x 31 cm
signed and dated on lower left

£ 2,000 - 3,000
(US\$ 2,568 - 3,853)

Provenance: Private Collection, Asia



Artist with the present lot



807

KOEBOE SARAWAN

(b. 1961, Indonesian)

Imaji Wayang

2018; oil on canvas; 67 x 76 cm

signed and dated on lower right

inscribed, signed and dated on the reverse

£ 3,600 - 4,600

(US\$ 4,625 - 5,910)

Provenance: Private Collection, Asia



808

YUKI THAM

(b.1992, Malaysian)

Chaos

2019; oil on canvas; 140 x 170 cm
signed and dated on lower left

£ 1,300 - 1,800
(US\$ 1,670 - 2,313)

Provenance: Private Collection, Asia

In this world full of joy and temptations, it is easy to go astray with these worldly things. The young so yearn to wonder in the journey of life, going through new adventures without thinking of possible consequences. The willingness and innocence in the heart goes against logic and consequences in the mind; resulting one to land in unsuited position. A position where one loses identity during a process of searching for a new one. In this painting i aim to capture the emotions and vulnerability of a person who is lost and confused.



809

MURNIASIH, I GUSTI AYU KADEK

(1966 - 2006, Indonesian)

Misteri

1998; acrylic on canvas; 40 x 30 cm
inscribed, signed and dated on the reverse

£ 1,200 - 1,700
(US\$ 1,542 - 2,184)

Provenance: Private Collection, Asia

This lot is accompanied with certificate of authenticity no. 0035/NG/00 dated November 21, 2000, from NADI GALLERY and signed by the artist.



IGAK Murniasih with the present lot



810

MURNIASIH, I GUSTI AYU KADEK

(1966 - 2006, Indonesian)

Purnama Berdasi

1995; acrylic on canvas; 60 x 40 cm
inscribed, signed and dated on the reverse

£ 2,000 - 3,000
(US\$ 2,568 - 3,853)

Provenance: Private Collection, Asia

This lot is accompanied with certificate of authenticity no. 0057/NG/00 dated November 21, 2000, from NADI GALLERY and signed by the artist.

Exhibition: *Fantasi Tubuh - I Gusti Ayu Kadek Murniasih*, Lingkar Becik Gallery (Bali), Nadi Gallery (Jakarta), October 2000. Illustrated on exhibition catalogue, p. back cover.



IGAK Murniasih with the present lot



811

JAYSON CORTEZ

(b. 1986, Filipino)

Fusion

2019; oil on canvas; 91 x 122 cm
signed and dated on lower left

£ 4,000 - 5,000
(US\$ 5,137 - 6,421)

The image of a man and his trusty steed brings about a feeling of reconnecting to one's basic instincts of forging relationships with animals such as horse that may be likened to the relationship between a man and his car. "Fusion" explores the idea of connection between a rider and a wild beast. As man is supposedly nature's keeper, this work reminds us of man's tendency to be drawn to work with nature, particularly through his connection with the horse which is not quite a vehicle but more so an ally.

- Marz Aglipay



812

ABI DIONISIO

(b. 1987, Filipino)

Hidden Sanctuary

2019; oil on canvas; 152 x 122 cm
signed and dated on lower right

£ 5,500 - 7,500

(US\$ 7,066 - 9,636)



814

JAYSON CORTEZ

(b. 1986, Filipino)

Mechanical Wings

2019; oil on canvas; 122 x 152 cm
signed and dated on lower left

£ 5,500 - 7,500
(US\$ 7,066 - 9,636)

The narrative of Cortez's "The Bogi man" continues in this piece, Mechanical Wings. The Bogi Man stands for what Cortez describes as the mysterious masculine figure that appears to be tough on the outside but is well attuned to his soft well-meaning nature. Mechanical Wings shows us of the Bogi man's dependence on his motorcycle, for some which can be viewed as a vehicle but ultimately for the Bogi man, it is an essential piece of his being, one which empowers him to pursue greater heights.

- Marz Aglipay

815

ANDRES BARRIOQUINTO

(b. 1975, Filipino)

In This Light and On That Evening

2019; oil on canvas; 152 x 122 cm
signed and dated on lower left

£ 30,000 - 40,000

(US\$ 38,526 - 51,368)





816

NAVARRO, JERRY ELIZALDE

(1924 - 1999, Philippines)

Awesome In Her Beauty

1996; acrylic on canvas; 122 x 91.5 x 5 cm with painted canvas on all sides; signed and dated on upper left; inscribed on lower left
signed, inscribed and dated on the reverse

£ 18,000 - 28,000
(US\$ 23,116 - 35,972)

Provenance: Private Collection, Asia



Navarro with the present lot
in his Manila studio, 1996

"Awesome in her beauty, when Mother Earth heaves and sighs, man trembles."

- J. E. Navarro



detail



817

WU GUAN ZHONG

(1919 - 2010, Chinese)

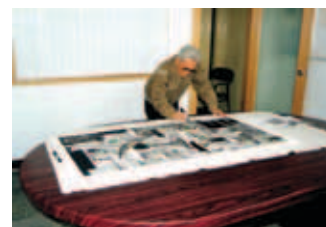
The Urban Net

2000; lithograph on rice paper, no. 80/100; 69 x 138.5 cm
signed on lower left in chinese characters, stamped with
artist's seal, numbered '80 / 100'

£ 2,800 - 3,800
(US\$ 3,597 - 4,882)

Provenance: Private Collection, Asia

This lot is accompanied with collection certificate from
Beijing Ever Bright Culture and Art Development Ltd.
Certificate signed by Wu Guan Zhong.



Artist with the present lot

Ships sail on the Tai Lake. There are a lot of black triangular flags on the water, just like crows which have lost their ways. These black triangular flags are not crows but signals indicating the nets under the water. They really damage the scenery of the Lake. There are no longer beautiful feelings when sailing on the Lake. Fishes can not swim freely for fear of getting into the nets. The fishes and shrimps are now having a hard life.

In the cities, there are a lot of buildings, reflecting the rich material life of the urban people. However, this can not cover up the hardships of the people's life, the merciless competition among them, just like the fishes and shrimps. Now, the urban people have fallen into the metropolitan nets and life-seeking nets.



818

FOUJITA, TSUGUHARU

(1886 - 1968, Japanese)

La Femme au Chat

1927; engraving on vellum; 35 x 45 cm
signed and inscribed "m/z" in pencil, on lower margin.

£ 5,000 - 7,000
(US\$ 6,421 - 8,989)

Provenance: Private Collection, Europe

The deluxe edition of 26 on vellum, aside from the edition on wove paper published by the Chalcographie du Louvre, Paris.



819

LE PHO

(1907 - 2001, Vietnamese)

Lady with Flower

watercolour on paper; 26.67 x 16.51 cm
signed on upper left

£ 2,200 - 3,200
(US\$ 2,826 - 4,111)

Provenance:

- Previously in the collection of Mr Raymond Cruz,
Miami, Florida, USA
- Private Collection, UK



820

VU CAO DAM

(1908 - 2000, Vietnamese)

Divinite

1964; watercolour on paper; 25.4 x 18.42 cm
signed and dated on lower left

£ 2,200 - 3,200
(US\$ 2,826 - 4,111)

Provenance:

- Previously in the collection of Mr Raymond Cruz,
Miami, Florida, USA
- Private Collection, UK



821

CHANG FEE MING

(b. 1959, Malaysian)

Good Morning

1992; watercolour on paper; 76 x 56 cm
signed on upper left

£ 12,000 - 15,000

(US\$ 15,410 - 19,263)

Provenance: Private Collection, Asia

This lot is accompanied with certificate of authenticity no.
C9F5M 029, signed by the artist.



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The Terms and Conditions shall be governed by and interpreted under the laws of the Singapore Special Administrative Region, and any matters not provided for herein shall be subject to the laws of the Singapore Special Administrative Region.

Arranging Payment

Please make payment by telegraphic transfer to One Larasati Arts account as stated in the invoice. Please include your name and invoice number with your instruction to your bank. One Larasati Arts does not accept credit cards as payment for purchase.

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Please email to:

c.e.metanfanuan@larasati.com

at least 24 hours before the sale.

Name (please print or type)

Date

Address

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(Mobile)

City

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(Business)

email

*Please provide your copy of ID

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Signed (we must have your signature to execute this bid)

Prospective bidders are reminded that the auction will be conducted in Pound Sterling (GBP).

Lot No.	Catalogue / Description	Top limit of Bid in GBP, not including the buyer's premium
		£
		£
		£
		£
		£
		£

(please print or type)

Lot No.	Catalogue / Description	Top limit of Bid in GBP, not including the buyer's premium
		£
		£
		£
		£
		£
		£

(Bid is per lot number as listed in the catalogue)

EXPLANATION OF CATALOGUING PRACTICE

Terms used in this catalogue have the meanings ascribed to them below. Please note that all statements in this catalogue as to authorship are made subject to the provisions of the Condition of Sale and Limited Warranty.

Buyers are advised to inspect the property themselves. Written conditions reports are usually available on request.

Name(s) or recognised designation of an artist without any qualification

In One Larasati Arts's opinion a work by the artist.

"Attributed to..."

In One Larasati Arts's qualified opinion probably a work by the artist in whole or in part.

"Studio of..." / "Workshop of..."

In One Larasati Arts's qualified opinion a work executed in the studio or workshop of the artist, possibly under his supervision.

"Circle of..."

In One Larasati Arts's qualified opinion a work of the period of the artist and showing his influence.

"Follower of..."

In One Larasati Arts's qualified opinion a work executed in the artist's style but not necessarily by a pupil.

"Manner of..."

In One Larasati Arts's qualified opinion a work executed in the artist's style but of a later date.

"After..."

In One Larasati Arts's qualified opinion a copy (of any date) of a work of the artist.

"Signed..." / "Dated..." / "Inscribed..."

In One Larasati Arts's qualified opinion the work has been signed/dated/inscribed by the artist.

"With signature..." / "With inscription..."

In One Larasati Arts's qualified opinion the signature/inscription appears to be by a hand other than that of the artist.

"With date..."

In One Larasati Arts's qualified opinion the date on the item was not executed on that date. The date given for Old Master, Modern and Contemporary Prints is the date (or approximate date when prefixed with 'circa') on which the matrix was worked and not necessarily the date when the impression was printed or published.

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